



Figure 4: zsh logo

contribute to it at <https://github.com/robbyrussell/oh-my-zsh>. It can be installed in two ways, either by using *Curl* or *wget*. *oh-my-zsh* uses Git, so you need to first install some packages in order to be able to install *oh-my-zsh*. Here's a list of them:

```
sudo apt-get install git-core curl
```

If you are using *Curl*, type:

```
curl -Lhttp://install.ohmyz.sh | sh
```

If you are using *wget*, type:

```
wget --no-check-certificate http://install.ohmyz.sh -O - | sh
```

Figure 5 shows how the installation looks on a Ubuntu 14.04 system.

If we use the above two commands, *oh-my-zsh* installs itself automatically. You can install it using *git* in the following manner:

```
p ~/git clone git://github.com/robbyrussell/oh-my-zsh.git
~/oh-my-zsh
cp ~/.zshrc ~/.zshrc.old
cp oh-my-zsh/.oh-my-zsh/templates/zshrc.zsh-template
~/.zshrc
```

Setting zsh as the default shell

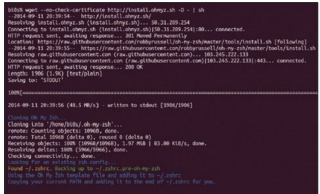
By default, *bash* is set as the shell in most modern distributions. You can change the default shell by using the *chsh* command:

```
chsh -s /bin/zsh username
```

Here, *username* is the one with which you are logged in. You can do the same with the root user but add *sudo* in front of it, as changing the shell for the root requires more privileges.



Note: By default, *oh-my-zsh* is installed only for the user.

Figure 5: Installing zsh using *wget*

Themes

By default, *oh-my-zsh* is set to its own theme, but you can set it to whatever you want to by changing line 10 of *~/.zshrc* to *random* or the name of the *zsh-theme* available on *~/.oh-my-zsh/themes/*. You can also choose your favourite themes by running the following commands at a terminal. There are a lot of themes available, and each has a different purpose -- some show the time, others show the battery level, etc.

```
cd ~/.oh-my-zsh/tools/
./theme_chooser.sh
```

After typing the above command, you will be shown a cool heading as the *zsh theme chooser*, which displays the preview of all the themes available in the folder *~/.oh-my-zsh/themes/* and asks whether to add the given template to your *favourites* list. There are also many tools available in the tools directory of *.oh-my-zsh*.

Updating oh-my-zsh

Updating *oh-my-zsh* is very easy. It can be done by typing *upgrade_oh_my_zsh* on the command line.

Why is zsh better than bash?

Here are a few reasons.

It's similar to bash: The foremost plus point of *zsh* is that it is backward-compatible with *bash*. Every valid command in *bash* becomes a valid command of *zsh* (except for a very few exceptions). Even if the *zsh* was more powerful than *bash*, it would have not been used by any one if it had some new and weird syntax. So if you know how to use a normal command line (*bash*), then you know the most powerful shell (*zsh*) syntax.

Spelling mistakes: It corrects almost all the spelling mistakes when you're using the command line. For example, in *bash*, if you type *cd /desk* and press the tab, it doesn't give us anything, but in *zsh*, it changes itself to *cd /Desktop*.

Intelligent tab completion: The tab completion doesn't just complete the last command but also checks for the whole line. For example, if you type *cd /u/l0/b* and hit a tab, it changes to *cd /usr/local/bin/*. Similarly, when you type *cd /u/*